



St. George's University

SCHOOL OF MEDICINE

Grenada, West Indies

St. George's University School of Medicine

Terms and Conditions for MDStart

Provisional Acceptance for Trial Period in the SGU School of Medicine

The Terms and Conditions listed below apply to all students who are provisionally accepted into the St. George's University School of Medicine ("SGUSOM" or "University") 4-year Doctor of Medicine Program ("MD-4 program") via the MDStart trial period. MDStart offers students a 14-week trial period in the first term of the MD Program and is meant to measure their readiness for medical school, as well as affording students the opportunity to confirm their interest and aptitude for medical school prior to making a full commitment to pursuing a degree in medicine at SGUSOM.

The following terms and conditions apply to your participation in MDStart:

1. General Rights and Restrictions

- a. You are not enrolled as a regular student in the MD Program, but you will be able to attend all Term 1 classes with regular students and will enjoy all the academic resources available to regular, fully admitted students.
- b. You are required to attend all classes in person. You will be subject to the same housing opportunities and requirements as a fully admitted student. University housing policies can be found in your St. George's University Housing Agreement.
- c. At any time during the MDStart trial period, you may elect to opt out of the program and return home, with no tuition or fees assessed or due to SGUSOM.
- d. Except where explicitly stated otherwise, you are subject to all University policies as described in the University Student Manual ([found here](#)) and the School of Medicine Student Manual ([found here](#)). However, you will not be eligible to repeat a course via "credit remediation" (described in section 6).
- e. Tuition and fees will not be charged during the MDStart trial period, but you remain financially responsible for the cost of housing, books, travel, other living expenses, medical air evacuation and health insurance (if not waived) (collectively the "Upfront Costs") during the trial period regardless of whether you successfully complete MDStart or not.
- f. MDStart students are eligible to participate in the White Coat Ceremony in the same manner as all regular, fully admitted Term 1 students. Participation in the White Coat Ceremony does not mean you are fully enrolled in the School of Medicine. Full enrollment is available only at the successful conclusion of the trial period, as outlined in this Terms and Conditions document.

2. Requirements of the MDStart Trial Period

- a. The end of the 14-week trial period marks the end of MDStart, and at that time you must notify SGUSOM if you do or do not wish to enroll in the MD Program. If you have met SGUSOM academic standards for MDStart (found in Section 3), and choose to continue:
 - (I) You will enroll as a regular student in the MD-4 Program and finish Term 1.
 - (II) MD-4 program Term 1 tuition and fees will be assessed at this time.
 - (III) If at the end of Term 1 you continue to meet all academic requirements, you will then receive full academic credit for the courses completed during the term.
- b. If at the end of the 14-week trial period you choose not to enroll in the MD-4 program:
 - (I) there will be no tuition/fees assessed or due to SGUSOM and no academic credit will be awarded.
 - (II) you will remain responsible for all Upfront Costs including any private or institutional loan used to pay for these costs.
 - (III) you will not be eligible for any future MDStart trial period.
 - (IV) you will be required to vacate the University dormitory promptly and return home. The Dean of Students Office can work with students to define the move out date depending upon individual circumstances.



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- c. If at the end of the 14-week trial period you do not meet the minimum academic standards:
- (I) you will not be given the option to repeat any courses or continue.
 - (II) there will be no tuition/fees assessed or due to SGUSOM and no academic credit will be awarded.
 - (III) you will remain responsible for all Upfront Costs and any private or institutional loan used to pay for these costs.
 - (IV) you will be required to vacate the University dormitory within 7 days and return home. Students with exceptional circumstances can work with the Dean of Students Office to define an alternate move out date.
 - (V) there is no appeal. MDStart students that are unsuccessful during the trial period are ineligible to reapply to SGU for a period of 3 calendar years.

3. MDStart Academic Standards

- a. A successful trial period is defined as maintaining good academic standing after the first 14-weeks of participation of Term 1 of the MD-4 program.

Good academic standing is defined as compliance with all course requirements as outlined in the course syllabus, completion of all formative and summative assessments to that point and requiring an average course grade of greater than 69.5% by the time of the completion of the 4th exam at the 14 week of the course.

One examination can be missed in case of a medical excuse, but the determination of good standing will then be based on the examinations completed to the 14-week period only, minus the missed examination. Those continuing in the program will then be required to sit the completion exam for the missed examination at the regularly scheduled examination time at the end of term. LOA cannot be taken in this program.

- b. MDStart students are subject to all University and School of Medicine policies, except where explicitly stated otherwise.

4. Financial Aid

- a. US Federal Student Aid Eligibility

- (I) You are not eligible to receive US Federal student loans ("Federal Direct Loans") during your participation in MDStart because you are not a regularly enrolled student. If you successfully complete MDStart and enroll as an MD-4 program student, and if you meet Federal Direct Loan eligibility requirements, you will be able to receive Federal Direct Loan funds for Term 1 tuition and fees, as well as apply these funds to some or all your Upfront Costs.
- (II) If you have prior federal or private student loans, you are not eligible for an 'in-school' deferment during the trial period because you are not a regularly enrolled student. However, if you successfully complete the MDStart program and enroll in the MD-4 program, you will be reported as an enrolled student with a deferment effective as of the start of the MDStart trial period.
- (III) If you plan to use Federal Direct Loan funds following the end of the MDStart trial period, you must satisfy all US federal financial aid documentation requirements prior to beginning MDStart. However, the University will not process or disburse any Federal Direct Loan funds unless you enroll in the MD-4 program after the successful completion of MDStart.
- (IV) If you cannot pay the Upfront Costs during MDStart, you may seek private lending sources. If you are not eligible for private loans, SGU institutional loans for billed expenses may be available to you (US and Canadian students only).
- (V) Please note that US Citizens and permanent residents of the United States who attend the SGU SOM/NU program will not be eligible to receive USDOE loans throughout their medical education at SGU. Student federal loan eligibility, for all foreign medical schools, is dependent on taking the Basic Science portion of the program on the main campus.



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b. US Veterans Educational Benefits Eligibility

- (I) You are not eligible to receive US Veterans Educational Benefits during your participation in MDStart. If you successfully complete MDStart and enroll as an MD-4 program student, you will be assessed MD-4 program Term 1 tuition and fees. At that time, SGU can certify your eligibility for VA Benefits with the Department of Veteran Affairs.

c. Canadian Student Aid Eligibility

- (I) You are not eligible to receive Canadian Student Aid during your participation in MDStart. If you successfully complete MDStart and enroll as an MD-4 program student, you will be assessed MD-4 program Term 1 tuition and fees. At that time, SGU can complete the Certificate of Enrollment for Canadian Student Aid which confirms enrollment in the MD-4 program.
- (II) If you cannot pay the Upfront Costs during MDStart, you may seek private lending sources. If not eligible for private loans, SGU institutional loans for billed expenses may be available to you (US and Canadian students only).

5. Leave of Absence

- (I) MDStart students are not able to choose a Leave of Absence (LOA), the term used to describe an approved interruption of studies for part of a term or longer or a Credit Remediation (CR), the term used to describe the ability to repeat a course when a student is unlikely to meet academic standards for progress.
- (II) MDStart students who experience a catastrophic event during the trial period may be eligible to withdraw from the trial period. Students seeking permission to withdraw must contact the Dean of Students (DOS@sgu.edu) to discuss their specific situation. If a student is withdrawn for longer than 1 year, a new admission application must be submitted. Note that a new admission application warrants a new review by our committee on admissions and student is not guaranteed an offer of provisional acceptance, such as MDStart.

6. Credit Remediation

- a. MDStart students are not eligible to choose a Credit Remediation during the trial period, which means the student cannot repeat a course if the student is concerned about his or her ability to meet academic standards for progress in that course.

By signing below, you acknowledge that you have read, understand, and agree to the Terms and Conditions associated with the MDStart trial period. You understand that this offer of admission is provisional, and enrollment in the full MD-4 program depends on your meeting the required academic standards at the end of the trial period and your decision to enroll and continue with medical school training.

If there are any questions related to MDStart or its requirements, please contact our Admissions office for further clarification before completing this agreement. Completion and signing of this agreement signifies your full acceptance of all the MDStart requirements.

Student name (printed): _____

Student signature:  _____

Date: _____